Unrest in the Colonies · The readings

Nine events on the road to the American Revolution, 1763 to 1775, at four reading levels: Quick, Clear, Full, and Deep. The same facts at every level. These are the readings from unrest.mrbsocialstudies.org, printed.

> **The unrest scale students use:** 1 Barely noticed · 2 Grumbling · 3 Upset · 4 Angry · 5 Protest · 6 Fury · 7 Defiance · 8 Ready to fight.
> Each number means how angry people were and how many of them, from 1 (Almost nobody cares. Life goes on.) to 8 (Anger is everywhere, and people will risk their lives over it.).

1. Proclamation of 1763 1763 British Action

Quick: Short sentences, key words explained in the text

The French and Indian War ended in 1763. Britain won. After the war, Britain claimed the land west of the Appalachian Mountains.

That year, the king of Britain made a new rule. It was called the **Proclamation of 1763**. A **proclamation** is an official order. The rule said colonists could not settle west of the mountains. Native American nations already lived on that land. The king said colonists had to stay out.

Britain made the rule because it wanted to stop more fighting with Native American nations. But many colonists were angry. They wanted to move west to get good, cheap farmland. Now they could not. The rule also showed that Britain wanted more control over the colonies.

Clear: Plain words, a little more detail

A proclamation is an official announcement. In 1763, Britain made the Proclamation of 1763. It said colonists could not settle west of the Appalachian Mountains. Britain had just won that land in the French and Indian War. Now it was reserved for Native Americans.

Britain wanted to avoid more fighting with Native Americans. Leaders also thought colonists would be safer if they stayed east of the mountains. But many colonists were upset. They had hoped to move west and find cheap, good farmland. The order also showed that Britain wanted more control over the colonies.

Full: The grade-level reading

A "proclamation" is a formal announcement. In the Proclamation of 1763, the British announced that the land won during the French and Indian War—the land west of the Appalachian Mountains—would be reserved for Native Americans. Colonists were forbidden to settle in that area.

The British wanted to prevent any more wars with Native Americans. They hoped it would be easier to protect the colonists if they lived only in the lands east of the Appalachians.

The colonists were frustrated by the Proclamation of 1763. Not only were they now unable to move westward, to cheap fertile land as they had hoped, but the Proclamation also made it clear that the British intended to maintain even tighter control over the colonies than ever before.

Deep: Adds real quotes from the time and what historians argue

The Proclamation of 1763 was more than a boundary line; it revealed a clash of worldviews. To British officials, limiting westward settlement would prevent costly frontier wars and protect trade with Native nations. To many colonists, it felt like a betrayal — many veterans had been promised western land for fighting in the French and Indian War.

Letters from veterans and land speculators show deep frustration. George Washington privately called the measure "a temporary expedient to quiet the minds of the Indians," one he expected "must fall of course in a few years." (Mount Vernon Historical Library) Native nations, meanwhile, saw it as a rare British acknowledgment of Native land rights — a promise often ignored in practice.

The Proclamation exposed a growing divide in motive: Britain sought control and balance, while settlers sought autonomy and opportunity. What looked to London like peacekeeping looked to the colonies like an early act of oppression — a boundary line that started to wear down colonial trust in Britain.

KEY TERMS

- **Proclamation of 1763**: A British order banning colonial settlement west of the Appalachian Mountains after the French and Indian War. **(Unit 2 word)**
- **proclamation**: an official public order from the government
- **frontier**: the edge of settled land, where colonists met Native nations
- **boundary**: a line that marks a limit you are not supposed to cross

2. Quartering Act 1765 British Action

Quick: Short sentences, key words explained in the text

To **quarter** soldiers means to give them a place to stay. In 1765, Parliament passed the Quartering Act. **Parliament** is the group that makes laws for Britain. This law said the colonies had to give British soldiers places to stay. The soldiers stayed in barracks, inns, and empty buildings. **Barracks** are buildings where soldiers live. The law did not make families keep soldiers in their homes. The colonies also had to give the soldiers fuel, candles, and rides from place to place. The colonies had to pay for all of this.

Many colonists were angry. They did not trust the soldiers. They thought the soldiers came to control them, not to protect them. Colonists also felt that Britain should have asked them first.

Clear: Plain words, a little more detail

To quarter means to give soldiers a place to stay. The Quartering Act made the colonies house British soldiers. The soldiers stayed in barracks, inns, and empty buildings, not in private homes. The colonies also had to give them fuel, candles, and transportation.

This law made many colonists angry. They did not trust the soldiers. They believed the troops came to control them, not to protect them. Colonists also felt Britain should have asked them first before passing such a law.

Full: The grade-level reading

"To quarter" means to give soldiers a place to stay. The Quartering Act required the colonies to house British soldiers in barracks, inns, and unoccupied buildings. In addition, colonists had to provide fuel, candles, beer and transportation for the troops.

The Quartering Act angered the colonists. They were suspicious of troops. They believed that they had been sent to America not to protect colonists but to control them. The colonists also felt that the British should have asked for their approval before passing an act that affected their personal lives and their pocketbooks.

Deep: Adds real quotes from the time and what historians argue

The Quartering Act forced colonists to house and supply British soldiers — a demand that cut to the heart of local control. British officers claimed the law ensured safety and order; colonists saw armed strangers sleeping in their towns as a symbol of mistrust.

Critics accused Parliament of keeping a standing army in the colonies in time of peace. In New York, the assembly refused to pay for soldiers' supplies until Parliament passed a law threatening to suspend it. (Britannica) To British eyes, that was rebellion. To colonists, it was defense of principle.

The act's real power was psychological. It turned distant government into daily intrusion — a soldier on your street, a cost on your table. Many colonists began to wonder: if Britain could make colonies pay to house its soldiers without their consent, what liberty could it not touch?

KEY TERMS

- **to quarter**: to give soldiers a place to live, plus food and supplies
- **troops**: soldiers
- **barracks**: buildings where soldiers live

3. Stamp Act 1765 British Action

Quick: Short sentences, key words explained in the text

After the French and Indian War, Britain owed a lot of money. British leaders thought the colonists should help pay for their own protection. So in 1765, Parliament passed the Stamp Act. **Parliament** is the group that makes laws for Britain. The Stamp Act was a **tax** on paper things, like newspapers and playing cards. A tax is money people must pay to the government. Colonists had to buy a stamp to show they paid.

The colonists were angry because they could not vote for anyone in Parliament. No one there spoke for them. They called this **taxation without representation**.

Colonists fought back in many ways. The Sons of Liberty scared the stamp sellers into quitting. Merchants (people who sell goods) started a **boycott**. A boycott is when people agree together not to buy something, to protest. They would not buy British goods. Leaders from nine colonies met. This meeting was called the Stamp Act Congress. They asked Britain to **repeal** the law. Repeal means to cancel a law.

In 1766, Parliament did repeal the Stamp Act. But on the same day, Parliament passed another law. It said Parliament could still make laws for the colonies. So the anger did not go away.

Clear: Plain words, a little more detail

After the French and Indian War, Britain was deep in debt. Leaders felt the colonists should help pay for their defense. So in 1765, Parliament passed the Stamp Act. It put a tax on printed paper, like newspapers, licenses, and playing cards. Colonists had to buy a stamp for each item to show they had paid.

The colonists were angry. They had no representatives in Parliament to vote on the tax. They called this "taxation without representation." The Sons of Liberty scared stamp sellers into quitting and blocked stamped paper at the docks. Merchants held a boycott, agreeing not to buy British goods. Leaders from nine colonies met as the Stamp Act Congress and asked Britain to repeal, or cancel, the law. Parliament did repeal it, but the anger kept growing.

Full: The grade-level reading

The British were in debt after the French and Indian War. They felt that the colonists should help pay for some of the expenses involved in defending the colonies from the French. The Stamp Act, passed in 1765, required the colonists to pay a tax on most printed materials, such as newspapers, pamphlets, marriage licenses, and playing cards. A colonist had to purchase a stamp and place it on any printed document to prove they had paid the tax.

The colonists were very angered by the Stamp Act. They weren't upset about just having to pay the tax. They felt that their freedom had been threatened because they had no say in the making of the law. The colonists resented being taxed without their consent, and they called it "taxation without representation."

Throughout the colonies, people responded in a number of ways. The Sons of Liberty forced stamp sellers to quit and stopped stamped papers from being unloaded at docks. Merchants organized a boycott of British goods. They agreed not to buy anything British. Representatives from nine colonies formed the Stamp Act Congress and declared that the stamp taxes could not be collected without the consent of the colonists. They demanded that Parliament repeal, or do away with, the act. Eventually, Parliament repealed the Stamp Act.

Deep: Adds real quotes from the time and what historians argue

The Stamp Act touched everyone — merchants, lawyers, sailors, even tavern keepers. It taxed paper goods and stamped each with the mark of royal authority. Parliament argued it was fair: the colonies should help pay for their own defense. But for many colonists, it was the first undeniable sign that London saw them as subjects, not partners.

Pamphlets cried, "No taxation without representation!" — a slogan that echoed from Virginia to Massachusetts. James Otis, an early protest leader, is often credited with the idea that taxation without representation was a form of tyranny — a phrase that became a rallying cry, though his exact words for that slogan were never recorded. (Massachusetts Historical Society) Boycotts spread, uniting merchants, printers, and farmers in a common cause. Even Benjamin Franklin, still loyal to Britain, testified in 1766 before Parliament that the colonists deeply resented the tax and would resist paying it. (UK Parliament Archives)

By repealing the law in 1766, Britain admitted defeat — but too late. The Stamp Act taught colonists that shared resistance could work, and that liberty was not just an idea but a practice. Each meeting, boycott, and petition gave colonists practice at organized resistance.

KEY TERMS

- **tax**: money people are required to pay to the government

- **Taxation without Representation**: Being taxed by a government in which you have no elected voice. **(Unit 2 word)**
- **Boycott**: An organized refusal to buy certain goods as a form of protest. **(Unit 2 word)**
- **Repeal**: To officially cancel a law. **(Unit 2 word)**
- **Sons of Liberty**: a group of colonists who organized protests against British taxes

4. Townshend Acts 1767 British Action

Quick: Short sentences, key words explained in the text

In 1767, Parliament passed new taxes called the Townshend Acts. A British leader named Charles Townshend planned them. They were taxes on glass, lead, paint, paper, and tea. The taxes were paid at the ports, when ships came in. So the tax was hidden inside the price at the store. Townshend hoped colonists would not be as upset.

But colonists noticed the taxes. They still could not vote for anyone in Parliament. So again they called it **taxation without representation**. To protest, colonists started another **boycott**. They would not buy British goods.

In 1770, Parliament **repealed** most of these taxes. Repeal means to cancel a law. But Parliament kept the tax on tea.

Clear: Plain words, a little more detail

Charles Townshend was a British official in charge of money. He planned new taxes, and in 1767 Parliament passed them. They taxed lead, glass, paper, paint, and tea. These taxes were indirect. That means they were collected at the ports, before goods reached the stores. The cost was hidden inside the price. Townshend hoped colonists would be less upset this way.

But the colonists still noticed the taxes. They had no representatives in Parliament to vote on them. Once again, they called it "taxation without representation." To protest, they boycotted British goods. They refused to buy anything made in Britain. In 1770, Parliament repealed most of the Townshend taxes, but it kept the tax on tea.

Full: The grade-level reading

Charles Townshend, a powerful British official in charge of the treasury (the Chancellor of the Exchequer), planned a small indirect tax on lead, glass, paper, paint and tea, and Parliament passed it in 1767. The tax was "indirect" because it was collected at the sea ports before the items reached colonial stores. Since the tax was built into the price the colonists paid at the stores—rather than added on visibly like the Stamp Act—Townshend hoped colonists would object to it less. (They did not: the duties were openly known and quickly resisted.)

The colonists, however, recognized the indirect tax. They saw it as an unjust form of TAXATION WITHOUT REPRESENTATION, since they had no representatives in Parliament from the colonies to vote on these taxes. As under the Stamp Act, they organized a boycott of British goods. In 1770, Parliament repealed all of the Townshend duties except the tax on tea.

Deep: Adds real quotes from the time and what historians argue

The portrait with this placard shows Charles Townshend, the British Chancellor of the Exchequer. His acts placed new import duties on glass, paint, paper, and tea — ordinary items that suddenly became symbols of control. Townshend claimed the taxes were modest and necessary for order. But colonists saw manipulation: the revenue paid royal officials, cutting assemblies out of power.

Merchants felt both economic pain and moral outrage. Years earlier, in 1764, James Otis Jr., a lawyer and politician from Massachusetts, had written, "...the very act of taxing, exercised over those who are not represented, appears to me to be depriving them of one of their most essential rights, as freemen; and if continued, seems to be in effect an entire disfranchisement of every civil right" (AmericanRevolution.org) Women joined in too; spinning bees became acts of protest, replacing imported fabric with homespun cloth. These "Daughters of Liberty" gave rebellion a domestic voice.

The acts blurred everyday life and empire. To the British, taxation was administration; to colonists, it was alienation. Every boycott, every homespun dress, turned politics into practice — and deepened the habit of resistance.

KEY TERMS

- **Taxation without Representation**: Being taxed by a government in which you have no elected voice. **(Unit 2 word)**
- **Boycott**: An organized refusal to buy certain goods as a form of protest. **(Unit 2 word)**
- **Repeal**: To officially cancel a law. **(Unit 2 word)**
- **indirect tax**: a tax built into a price and collected before goods reach the store
- **non-importation**: an agreement to stop importing (bringing in) British goods
- **customs**: taxes on goods entering a place — and the officials who collect them
- **smuggling**: bringing goods in secretly to avoid paying taxes

5. Boston Massacre 1770 Both Sides Clash

Quick: Short sentences, key words explained in the text

On March 5, 1770, a crowd in Boston yelled at British soldiers. Some people threw snowballs at them. Things got out of control. The soldiers fired their guns into the crowd. Five colonists died. People called this the Boston Massacre.

Most colonists blamed the soldiers. The people of Boston held a town meeting. They wanted the soldiers to leave Boston. They wanted the soldiers to go on trial for murder. The governor of Massachusetts agreed. The soldiers moved out of the town. Later, the soldiers went on trial.

Paul Revere printed a famous picture of the event. It is not the picture on this placard. It spread fast, so many colonists got even angrier. But the picture did not show the whole story. The real night was more confusing than the picture. John Adams was the soldiers' lawyer in court. Not everyone agreed about who was to blame.

Clear: Plain words, a little more detail

On March 5, 1770, colonists in Boston shouted at British soldiers. Some threw snowballs at them. The situation got out of control, and the soldiers fired into the crowd. Five colonists were killed. People called it the Boston Massacre.

Most colonists blamed the soldiers. Angry citizens held a town meeting. They demanded that the troops leave Boston and stand trial for murder. The acting governor agreed. The troops moved out of town, and the soldiers were later tried in court. Paul Revere printed a famous picture of the event (not the picture on this placard). It spread fast and made many colonists even angrier — even though the real story was messier than the picture showed.

Full: The grade-level reading

On March 5, 1770, a crowd of colonists in Boston began to harass British troops, taunting them and throwing snowballs. The situation soon got out of hand, and finally the troops opened fire. Five colonists died. Colonists soon called it the Boston Massacre.

Most colonists believed that the British soldiers were completely at fault. The enraged citizens of Boston called a town meeting to demand the removal of the British troops and to argue for the trial of the British soldiers for murder. The acting governor agreed: the troops moved to an island fort in the harbor, and the soldiers were later tried in a local court.

Paul Revere made a famous engraving of the event (not the picture on this placard) that spread across the colonies and made many people angrier—even though the real story was messier than the picture showed. Later, John Adams defended the soldiers in court, a reminder that people at the time did not all agree about who was to blame.

Deep: Adds real quotes from the time and what historians argue

Paul Revere's famous engraving of the Boston Massacre turned confusion into clarity. (The picture with this placard is a later illustration, made long after 1770.) In his version, disciplined redcoats fire into a helpless crowd. The truth was messier: chaos, fear, and snowballs on a freezing March night. For soldiers, surrounded and taunted, it was self-defense. For colonists, it was proof that Britain ruled through violence.

Within weeks, Revere's image spread across the colonies, stoking outrage. Yet another voice emerged — John Adams — who risked his reputation to defend the soldiers, reminding Bostonians that "facts are stubborn things." (Founders.gov)

The event showed how images could shape truth. Revere had actually copied his engraving from one by Henry Pelham, who accused him of stealing the design — an irony inside a story about truth and propaganda. Revere's engraving reminds us that propaganda (information meant to influence opinion) became a revolutionary tool. The massacre's legacy wasn't just five deaths — it was the realization that perception could unite a movement faster than armies could suppress it.

KEY TERMS

- **massacre**: the killing of many people, often unarmed
- **propaganda**: information spread to shape how people feel about something

6. Boston Tea Party 1773 Colonial Response

Quick: Short sentences, key words explained in the text

In 1773, Parliament passed the Tea Act. The law helped one British company, the East India Company. It let the company sell tea very cheaply. That hurt colonial sellers, because they could not sell tea for such a low price.

The tea was cheaper. But it still had a tax on it. The colonists did not vote for that tax. If they bought the tea, it would be like saying Parliament could tax them. So this was **taxation without representation** again.

To protest, the Sons of Liberty planned the Boston Tea Party. Some colonists dressed up like Mohawk Indians. That way, no one would know who they were. They climbed onto three ships that carried the company's tea. They dumped 342 chests of tea into Boston Harbor. A **chest** is a big wooden box. A big crowd watched.

Clear: Plain words, a little more detail

In 1773, Parliament passed the Tea Act. It gave one company, the British East India Company, a special advantage. The company could sell tea very cheaply. This hurt colonial merchants and smugglers, who could not match the low price.

Even though tea was now cheaper, the colonists were angry. Britain had made a decision for them without asking. The tea still had a tax on it, and buying it would mean accepting Parliament's right to tax them. To protest, the Sons of Liberty planned the Boston Tea Party. Colonists disguised as Mohawk Indians boarded three ships carrying the company's tea. They dumped 342 chests of tea into Boston Harbor while a large crowd watched.

Full: The grade-level reading

In 1773 Parliament passed the Tea Act, which gave the British East India Company a major advantage in the American tea business—letting it sell tea so cheaply that it undercut colonial merchants and smuggled Dutch tea.

Despite the fact that this act actually lowered the price of tea, the colonists still opposed it. They viewed the Tea Act as merely another example of England making a decision that concerned the colonists without consulting them—and the tea still carried the Townshend tax.

To protest the Tea Act, the Sons of Liberty organized the Boston Tea Party. Dressed as Native Americans, colonists raided three ships carrying East India Company tea in Boston harbor. They smashed open 342 chests of tea and dumped them into the harbor, while a crowd of people watched in approval.

Deep: Adds real quotes from the time and what historians argue

The print with this placard, made in 1846, imagines men disguised as Mohawk warriors on the tea ships in Boston Harbor — a theatrical act with enormous consequences. The Boston Tea Party began as an argument over principle: even a cheap tax was still tyranny.

British lawmakers thought colonists would accept the bargain — cheaper tea through a special advantage critics called a monopoly. Instead, they underestimated pride. Boston town meetings argued that buying the taxed tea would mean admitting Parliament's right to tax the colonies. (Massachusetts Historical Society) The protestors' disguises symbolized freedom and identity — colonists rejecting Britishness and adopting American defiance.

To the British, this was criminal destruction of property; to the colonists, it was moral purification. The print freezes that moment — unity, disguise, rebellion. News of the protest spread quickly through the colonies and back to Britain. Within months, Britain would strike back with punishment so severe it erased any illusion of reconciliation.

KEY TERMS

- **Taxation without Representation**: Being taxed by a government in which you have no elected voice. **(Unit 2 word)**
- **monopoly**: complete control of a market by one company
- **undercut**: to sell at a lower price than a competitor to take away their business
- **protest**: an action that shows strong public disagreement

7. Intolerable (Coercive) Acts 1774 British Action

Quick: Short sentences, key words explained in the text

To **coerce** means to force someone to do something. After the Boston Tea Party, Britain wanted to punish Boston. So in 1774, Parliament passed the Coercive Acts. These laws closed the port of Boston, so ships could not come in or go out. The port would stay closed until Boston paid for the tea. The king also put an army general, Thomas Gage, in charge of Massachusetts. More soldiers came to Boston. The laws also limited town meetings.

Colonists were shocked. They called the laws the **Intolerable Acts**. **Intolerable** means too harsh to accept. The laws only punished Massachusetts. But the other colonies were worried, because they could be next. So they joined the protest. Some colonies sent food to Boston.

Near Boston, minutemen got ready to fight. **Minutemen** were colonists who could be ready to fight very fast, "at a minute's notice." They stored guns and gunpowder, and they trained for battle.

Clear: Plain words, a little more detail

To coerce means to force someone to do something. After the Boston Tea Party, Britain wanted to punish the colonists. Parliament passed the Coercive Acts. These laws closed the port of Boston. They put Massachusetts under military rule and sharply limited town meetings.

The colonists were shocked. They called the laws the "Intolerable Acts" because they were too harsh to accept. The laws targeted only Massachusetts, but other colonies joined the protest. They feared losing their own freedoms next. Samuel Adams helped organize the resistance. In towns near Boston, "minutemen" — colonists ready to fight quickly — began storing weapons and training for battle.

Full: The grade-level reading

"To coerce" means to force someone to do something. The British passed the Coercive Acts in reaction to the Boston Tea Party. They hoped to force colonists to pay for the tea lost and to obey British rule. The Coercive Acts closed the port of Boston and imposed military rule on all of Massachusetts. The Massachusetts legislature and town meetings were sharply restricted.

Samuel Adams helped to stir up colonial response to these acts. The colonists called the acts the "Intolerable Acts" because they did not feel that they could tolerate them. The taxes they had been battling were nothing in comparison to this harsh British crackdown on colonial rights.

Although the acts applied only to Massachusetts, the other colonies rallied to protest them. The colonists feared that if such British Actions were to continue, the rest of the colonies were in danger of losing their liberties as well. On the day the acts went into effect, flags throughout the colonies were flown at half-mast. Meanwhile, in the towns surrounding Boston, "minutemen" began to store arms and to train for possible battle "at a minute's notice".

Deep: Adds real quotes from the time and what historians argue

The cartoon with this placard, "The Able Doctor" (1774), shows British officials forcing tea down the throat of a woman who stands for America — punishment in picture form. The Intolerable Acts (called the Coercive Acts in Britain) shut down the port, replaced local leaders, and stationed troops inside the city. To Parliament, this was discipline; to colonists, it was collective suffering. Merchants went bankrupt, workers lost their jobs and went hungry, and neighbors from as far away as Virginia sent food to the blockaded city. In a 1774 letter from George Washington to George William Fairfax:

> *"In short the Ministry may rely on it ... that Americans will never be tax'd without their own consent; that the cause of Boston, the despotick measures in respect to it, I mean now is and ever will be consider'd as the cause of America..." (MountVernon.org)*

What London intended as isolation instead created unity. The cartoon captures how it felt to be punished by a government you had no voice in. Across the colonies, people who had once felt distant now shared a common outrage. The Intolerable Acts didn't just close Boston — they opened the road to revolution.

KEY TERMS

- **Intolerable Acts**: The 1774 laws punishing Massachusetts for the Boston Tea Party, which Britain called the Coercive Acts. **(Unit 2 word)**
- **coercive**: using force or threats to make people obey

- **charter**: a document that grants rights or self-government
- **blockade**: closing a port so ships cannot enter or leave
- **legislature**: the group of people who make a colony's laws
- **minutemen**: militia ready to fight at a minute's notice

8. First Continental Congress 1774 Colonial Response

Quick: Short sentences, key words explained in the text

After the Intolerable Acts, the colonies decided to work together. They knew they were stronger together than alone. They wanted to tell Britain their complaints as one group.

In 1774, leaders from 12 of the 13 colonies met in Philadelphia. This meeting was called the **First Continental Congress**. A **congress** is a meeting of people chosen to speak for others. Samuel Adams, John Adams, George Washington, and Patrick Henry were there.

They met for about seven weeks. They wrote down the rights they believed colonists had. They sent a letter to the king. They also agreed to a big **boycott**. First, colonists would stop buying British goods. Later, if Britain did not listen, they would also stop selling goods to Britain. Local groups made sure people obeyed the boycott.

Clear: Plain words, a little more detail

After the Coercive Acts, the colonies decided to work together more closely than ever before. They knew that if they stayed divided, they could lose their rights. They wanted to send their complaints to Britain as one group.

In 1774, representatives from 12 of the 13 colonies met in Philadelphia. This meeting was the First Continental Congress. Leaders like Samuel Adams, John Adams, George Washington, and Patrick Henry attended. After seven weeks, they wrote a Declaration of Rights and letters to the King. They also agreed to boycott British trade. Local committees made sure people followed the boycott.

Full: The grade-level reading

As a result of the Coercive Acts, the colonies put aside their individual differences and agreed to work together more closely than ever before to protect their collective rights. They felt they needed to present their complaints to the British as a unified group.

Representatives from 12 of the 13 colonies met and formed the First Continental Congress. They met in Carpenters' Hall in Philadelphia. Men such as Samuel Adams, John Adams, George Washington and Patrick Henry attended.

After seven weeks, the Congress drew up the Declaration of Rights, as well as appeals to the King and to the British people. In addition, Congress called for a complete boycott of all trade with England. Imports from England would stop at once; exports would stop later if Britain did not respond. Local committees enforced the boycott by publicly shaming and boycotting violators —who were occasionally tarred and feathered.

Deep: Adds real quotes from the time and what historians argue

The painting with this placard, made decades later, shows the First Continental Congress opening with a prayer: ordinary men about to perform extraordinary politics. Representatives from 12 colonies met in Philadelphia to debate how to respond to British power.

Inside Carpenters' Hall, voices clashed. Some delegates, like Joseph Galloway, urged patience and a plan to stay united with Britain; others, like Patrick Henry, reportedly declared, "I am not a Virginian, but an American!" (Colonial Williamsburg) John Adams recorded the line in his notes of the debates, though as a summary rather than Henry's exact words. The Congress agreed on boycotts and began organizing local committees to enforce them.

The scene reminds us how the colonies transformed from scattered provinces into a united movement. This was the first rehearsal for self-government — with argument, compromise, and vision. Though still loyal to the king, the delegates had crossed a threshold: they were now speaking as Americans.

KEY TERMS

- **congress**: a formal meeting of chosen representatives
- **Boycott**: An organized refusal to buy certain goods as a form of protest. **(Unit 2 word)**
- **delegate**: a person chosen to represent a group
- **petition**: a formal written request to those in power

9. Lexington & Concord 1775 Both Sides Clash

Quick: Short sentences, key words explained in the text

Britain did not give the First Continental Congress what it asked for. In April 1775, British soldiers marched out of Boston. They went to the towns of Lexington and Concord. They wanted to take the colonists' guns and gunpowder. Colonists feared the soldiers also wanted to catch two leaders, Samuel Adams and John Hancock. Paul Revere rode at night to warn them.

At Lexington, minutemen met the British soldiers. Someone fired a shot, but no one knows who fired first. Eight colonists were killed. Then the British marched on to Concord. More minutemen fought them there.

The British turned back to Boston. On the way, colonists shot at them from behind trees and fences. By night, many more British soldiers than colonists were hurt or killed.

In June 1775, the Second Continental Congress chose George Washington to lead the colonists' army. The Revolutionary War had begun.

Clear: Plain words, a little more detail

Britain refused the requests from the First Continental Congress. In April 1775, British soldiers marched from Boston to Lexington and Concord. They wanted to seize the colonists' weapons and gunpowder. Colonists feared they also meant to capture the leaders Samuel Adams and John Hancock.

At Lexington, minutemen met the soldiers. No one knows who fired first, but eight colonists were killed and ten were wounded. The British pushed on to Concord, where more minutemen fought back. As the British retreated, colonists fired at them from behind trees and fences. By day's end, the British had 273 casualties, while the colonists had fewer than 100. Soon the Second Continental Congress chose George Washington to lead the new army. The Revolutionary War had begun.

Full: The grade-level reading

The King and Parliament rejected the demands of the First Continental Congress. In April 1775, British troops left Boston and marched to nearby Lexington and Concord. They planned to seize stores of colonial gunpowder and arms —and, colonists feared, to capture the "rebel" leaders Samuel Adams and John Hancock.

At Lexington, colonial minutemen—colonists who had joined the militia—met the British soldiers. No one knows who fired first, but when the smoke cleared, eight colonists were dead and ten were wounded. The "Redcoats" pushed on to Concord, where they were met by more minutemen. Then, while the British retreated back to Boston, minutemen fired on them from behind trees and fences. At day's end, the British suffered 273 casualties, while the colonists suffered less than one hundred.

After the battles of Lexington and Concord, thousands of minutemen from the area gathered around Boston in anticipation of the next battle. The Second Continental Congress met and drafted a new appeal to the King. They also selected George Washington to head the army of minutemen surrounding Boston. The Revolutionary War had begun.

Deep: Adds real quotes from the time and what historians argue

The painting with this placard, made in the 1880s, shows the fight on Lexington's village green — the moment when debate became war. On April 19, 1775, British soldiers marched to seize weapons at Concord; colonists feared they would also arrest rebel leaders Samuel Adams and John Hancock. But through the night, riders like Paul Revere, William Dawes, and Samuel Prescott spread the alarm that "the regulars are coming out." The popular shortened version — "the regulars are coming" — comes from later retellings, not Revere's own account.

At dawn in Lexington, nervous farmers faced the king's army. Captain John Parker reportedly ordered, "Stand your ground; don't fire unless fired upon; but if they mean to have a war, let it begin here." (American Battlefield Trust) Historians note that this quote comes from later accounts and family tradition, not Parker's own recorded words — a reminder that memory and myth often intertwine in revolutionary history.

To British commanders, these colonists were criminals. To the militia, they were defenders of natural rights. The scene captures not just battle but identity — ordinary people standing as citizens. Lexington and Concord transformed protest into revolution and revolution into a nation's beginning.

KEY TERMS

- **militia**: ordinary citizens trained to fight as part-time soldiers
- **redcoats**: British soldiers, named for their red uniforms

- **minutemen**: militia ready to fight at a minute's notice
- **casualties**: people killed or wounded

Quick in Español

The Quick readings, translated. Key unit terms keep the English word beside the translation.

1. Proclamation of 1763 1763

La Guerra Franco-Indígena terminó en 1763. Gran Bretaña ganó. Después de la guerra, Gran Bretaña reclamó las tierras al oeste de los montes Apalaches.

Ese año, el rey de Gran Bretaña hizo una nueva regla. Se llamó la **Proclamación de 1763** (*Proclamation of 1763*). Una **proclamación** es una orden oficial. La regla decía que los colonos no podían establecerse al oeste de las montañas. Las naciones indígenas americanas ya vivían en esas tierras. El rey dijo que los colonos tenían que quedarse fuera.

Gran Bretaña hizo la regla porque quería evitar más enfrentamientos con las naciones indígenas. Pero muchos colonos se enojaron. Querían mudarse al oeste para conseguir tierras de cultivo buenas y baratas. Ahora no podían. La regla también mostró que Gran Bretaña quería más control sobre las colonias.

2. Quartering Act 1765

Alojar (*to quarter*) soldados significa darles un lugar donde quedarse. En 1765, el Parlamento aprobó la Ley de Acuartelamiento (*Quartering Act*). El **Parlamento** es el grupo que hace las leyes de Gran Bretaña. Esta ley decía que las colonias tenían que darles a los soldados británicos lugares donde quedarse. Los soldados se quedaban en cuarteles, posadas y edificios vacíos. Los **cuarteles** son edificios donde viven los soldados. La ley no obligaba a las familias a tener soldados en sus casas. Las colonias también tenían que darles a los soldados combustible, velas y transporte de un lugar a otro. Las colonias tenían que pagar por todo esto.

Muchos colonos se enojaron. No confiaban en los soldados. Pensaban que los soldados venían a controlarlos, no a protegerlos. Los colonos también sentían que Gran Bretaña debería haberles preguntado primero.

3. Stamp Act 1765

Después de la Guerra Franco-Indígena, Gran Bretaña debía mucho dinero. Los líderes británicos pensaban que los colonos debían ayudar a pagar su propia protección. Por eso, en 1765, el Parlamento aprobó la Ley del Timbre (*Stamp Act*). El **Parlamento** es el grupo que hace las leyes de Gran Bretaña. La Ley del Timbre era un **impuesto** sobre cosas de papel, como periódicos y cartas de jugar. Un impuesto es dinero que la gente tiene que pagarle al gobierno. Los colonos tenían que comprar un timbre (un sello oficial) para mostrar que habían pagado.

Los colonos se enojaron porque no podían votar por nadie en el Parlamento. Nadie allí hablaba por ellos. A esto lo llamaron **impuestos sin representación** (*taxation without representation*).

Los colonos se resistieron de muchas maneras. Los Hijos de la Libertad (*Sons of Liberty*) asustaron a los vendedores de timbres para que renunciaran. Los comerciantes (personas que venden productos) empezaron un **boicot** (*boycott*). Un boicot es cuando la gente se pone de acuerdo para no comprar algo, como protesta. Se negaron a comprar productos británicos. Líderes de nueve colonias se reunieron. Esta reunión se llamó el Congreso de la Ley del Timbre (*Stamp Act Congress*). Le pidieron a Gran Bretaña que **derogara** (*repeal*) la ley. Derogar significa cancelar una ley.

En 1766, el Parlamento sí derogó la Ley del Timbre. Pero ese mismo día, el Parlamento aprobó otra ley. Decía que el Parlamento todavía podía hacer leyes para las colonias. Por eso, el enojo no desapareció.

4. Townshend Acts 1767

En 1767, el Parlamento aprobó nuevos impuestos llamados las Leyes Townshend (*Townshend Acts*). Un líder británico llamado Charles Townshend los planeó. Eran impuestos sobre el vidrio, el plomo, la pintura, el papel y el té. Los impuestos se pagaban en los puertos, cuando llegaban los barcos. Así, el impuesto quedaba escondido dentro del precio en la tienda. Townshend esperaba que los colonos no se enojaran tanto.

Pero los colonos se dieron cuenta de los impuestos. Todavía no podían votar por nadie en el Parlamento. Por eso, otra vez lo llamaron **impuestos sin representación** (*taxation without representation*). Para protestar, los colonos empezaron otro **boicot** (*boycott*). Se negaron a comprar productos británicos.

En 1770, el Parlamento **derogó** (*repealed*) la mayoría de estos impuestos. Derogar significa cancelar una ley. Pero el Parlamento mantuvo el impuesto sobre el té.

5. Boston Massacre 1770

El 5 de marzo de 1770, una multitud en Boston les gritó a unos soldados británicos. Algunas personas les tiraron bolas de nieve. La situación se salió de control. Los soldados dispararon sus armas contra la multitud. Murieron cinco colonos. La gente llamó a esto la Masacre de Boston (*Boston Massacre*).

La mayoría de los colonos culpó a los soldados. La gente de Boston organizó una asamblea de la ciudad. Querían que los soldados se fueran de Boston. Querían que los soldados fueran a juicio por asesinato. El gobernador de Massachusetts aceptó. Los soldados salieron de la ciudad. Más tarde, los soldados fueron a juicio.

Paul Revere imprimió una imagen famosa del suceso. No es la imagen de esta tarjeta. Se difundió rápido, así que muchos colonos se enojaron todavía más. Pero la imagen no mostraba toda la historia. Lo que pasó esa noche fue más confuso que la imagen. John Adams fue el abogado de los soldados en el juicio. No todos estaban de acuerdo sobre quién tenía la culpa.

6. Boston Tea Party 1773

En 1773, el Parlamento aprobó la Ley del Té (*Tea Act*). La ley ayudaba a una compañía británica, la Compañía de las Indias Orientales (*East India Company*). La ley le permitía a la compañía vender té muy barato. Eso perjudicó a los vendedores de las colonias, porque ellos no podían vender té a un precio tan bajo.

El té era más barato. Pero todavía tenía un impuesto. Los colonos no habían votado por ese impuesto. Si compraban el té, sería como decir que el Parlamento podía cobrarles impuestos. Por eso, esto era otra vez **impuestos sin representación** (*taxation without representation*).

Para protestar, los Hijos de la Libertad planearon el Motín del Té de Boston (*Boston Tea Party*). Algunos colonos se disfrazaron de indígenas mohawk. Así, nadie sabría quiénes eran. Subieron a tres barcos que llevaban el té de la compañía. Tiraron 342 cofres de té al puerto de Boston. Un **cofre** es una caja grande de madera. Una gran multitud miraba.

7. Intolerable (Coercive) Acts 1774

Coaccionar (*to coerce*) significa obligar a alguien a hacer algo. Después del Motín del Té, Gran Bretaña quería castigar a Boston. Por eso, en 1774, el Parlamento aprobó las Leyes Coercitivas (*Coercive Acts*). Estas leyes cerraron el puerto de Boston, así que los barcos no podían entrar ni salir. El puerto seguiría cerrado hasta que Boston pagara el té. El rey también puso a un general del ejército, Thomas Gage, a cargo de Massachusetts. Llegaron más soldados a Boston. Las leyes también limitaron las asambleas de los pueblos.

Los colonos quedaron impactados. Llamaron a las leyes las **Leyes Intolerables** (*Intolerable Acts*). **Intolerable** significa demasiado duro para aceptarlo. Las leyes solo castigaban a Massachusetts. Pero las otras colonias estaban preocupadas, porque podían ser las siguientes. Por eso se unieron a la protesta. Algunas colonias enviaron comida a Boston.

Cerca de Boston, los milicianos llamados *minutemen* se prepararon para pelear. Los **minutemen** eran colonos que podían estar listos para pelear muy rápido, “en un minuto”. Guardaron armas y pólvora, y entrenaron para la batalla.

8. First Continental Congress 1774

Después de las Leyes Intolerables, las colonias decidieron trabajar juntas. Sabían que eran más fuertes juntas que solas. Querían decirle a Gran Bretaña sus quejas como un solo grupo.

En 1774, líderes de 12 de las 13 colonias se reunieron en Filadelfia. Esta reunión se llamó el **Primer Congreso Continental** (*First Continental Congress*). Un **congreso** es una reunión de personas elegidas para hablar por otros. Samuel Adams, John Adams, George Washington y Patrick Henry estuvieron allí.

Se reunieron durante unas siete semanas. Escribieron los derechos que creían que tenían los colonos. Le enviaron una carta al rey. También acordaron un gran **boicot** (*boycott*). Primero, los colonos dejarían de comprar productos británicos. Después, si Gran Bretaña no escuchaba, también dejarían de venderle productos a Gran Bretaña. Grupos locales se aseguraron de que la gente cumpliera el boicot.

9. Lexington & Concord 1775

Gran Bretaña no le dio al Primer Congreso Continental lo que pedía. En abril de 1775, soldados británicos salieron de Boston. Fueron a los pueblos de Lexington y Concord. Querían quitarles a los colonos sus armas y su pólvora. Los colonos temían que los soldados también quisieran atrapar a dos líderes, Samuel Adams y John Hancock. Paul Revere cabalgó de noche para avisarles.

En Lexington, los minutemen se enfrentaron a los soldados británicos. Alguien disparó, pero nadie sabe quién disparó primero. Mataron a ocho colonos. Luego los británicos siguieron hacia Concord. Allí más minutemen pelearon contra ellos.

Los británicos regresaron a Boston. En el camino, los colonos les dispararon desde detrás de árboles y cercas. Esa noche, había muchos más soldados británicos que colonos muertos o heridos.

En junio de 1775, el Segundo Congreso Continental (*Second Continental Congress*) eligió a George Washington para dirigir el ejército de los colonos. La Guerra de Independencia de Estados Unidos (*Revolutionary War*) había comenzado.

Quick in Português

The Quick readings, translated. Key unit terms keep the English word beside the translation.

1. Proclamation of 1763 1763

A Guerra Franco-Indígena terminou em 1763. A Grã-Bretanha venceu. Depois da guerra, a Grã-Bretanha disse que as terras a oeste dos Montes Apalaches eram suas.

Naquele ano, o rei da Grã-Bretanha fez uma nova regra. Essa regra se chamava **Proclamação de 1763** (*Proclamation of 1763*). Uma **proclamação** é uma ordem oficial. A regra dizia que os colonos não podiam se estabelecer a oeste das montanhas. Povos indígenas já viviam nessas terras. O rei disse que os colonos tinham que ficar de fora.

A Grã-Bretanha fez a regra porque queria evitar mais lutas com os povos indígenas. Mas muitos colonos ficaram com raiva. Eles queriam se mudar para o oeste para conseguir terras boas e baratas para plantar. Agora não podiam. A regra também mostrou que a Grã-Bretanha queria mais controle sobre as colônias.

2. Quartering Act 1765

Aquartelar (*to quarter*) soldados quer dizer dar a eles um lugar para ficar. Em 1765, o Parlamento aprovou a Lei do Aquartelamento (*Quartering Act*). O **Parlamento** é o grupo que faz as leis da Grã-Bretanha. Essa lei dizia que as colônias tinham que dar lugares para os soldados britânicos ficarem. Os soldados ficavam em quartéis, pousadas e prédios vazios. **Quartéis** são prédios onde os soldados moram. A lei não obrigava as famílias a ter soldados em suas casas. As colônias também tinham que dar aos soldados combustível, velas e transporte de um lugar para outro. As colônias tinham que pagar por tudo isso.

Muitos colonos ficaram com raiva. Eles não confiavam nos soldados. Achavam que os soldados vinham para controlá-los, e não para protegê-los. Os colonos também achavam que a Grã-Bretanha devia ter perguntado a eles primeiro.

3. Stamp Act 1765

Depois da Guerra Franco-Indígena, a Grã-Bretanha devia muito dinheiro. Os líderes britânicos achavam que os colonos deviam ajudar a pagar pela sua própria proteção. Por isso, em 1765, o Parlamento aprovou a Lei do Selo (*Stamp Act*). O **Parlamento** é o grupo que faz as leis da Grã-Bretanha. A Lei do Selo era um **imposto** sobre coisas de papel, como jornais e cartas de baralho. Imposto é o dinheiro que as pessoas têm que pagar ao governo. Os colonos tinham que comprar um selo para mostrar que tinham pago.

Os colonos ficaram com raiva porque não podiam votar em ninguém no Parlamento. Ninguém lá falava por eles. Eles chamaram isso de **taxação sem representação** (*taxation without representation*).

Os colonos reagiram de muitas formas. Os Filhos da Liberdade (*Sons of Liberty*) assustaram os vendedores de selos até eles desistirem. Os comerciantes (pessoas que vendem produtos) começaram um **boicote** (*boycott*). Boicote é quando as pessoas combinam de não comprar algo, para protestar. Eles se recusaram a comprar produtos britânicos. Líderes de nove colônias se reuniram. Essa reunião foi chamada de Congresso da Lei do Selo (*Stamp Act Congress*). Eles pediram à Grã-Bretanha que **revogasse** (*repeal*) a lei. Revogar quer dizer cancelar uma lei.

Em 1766, o Parlamento revogou a Lei do Selo. Mas, no mesmo dia, o Parlamento aprovou outra lei. Ela dizia que o Parlamento ainda podia fazer leis para as colônias. Por isso, a raiva não passou.

4. Townshend Acts 1767

Em 1767, o Parlamento aprovou novos impostos chamados Leis Townshend (*Townshend Acts*). Um líder britânico chamado Charles Townshend os planejou. Eram impostos sobre vidro, chumbo, tinta, papel e chá. Os impostos eram pagos nos portos, quando os navios chegavam. Assim, o imposto ficava escondido dentro do preço na loja. Townshend esperava que os colonos não ficassem tão irritados.

Mas os colonos perceberam os impostos. Eles ainda não podiam votar em ninguém no Parlamento. Então, de novo, chamaram isso de **taxação sem representação** (*taxation without representation*). Para protestar, os colonos começaram outro **boicote** (*boycott*). Eles se recusaram a comprar produtos britânicos.

Em 1770, o Parlamento **revogou** (*repealed*) a maioria desses impostos. Revogar quer dizer cancelar uma lei. Mas o Parlamento manteve o imposto sobre o chá.

5. Boston Massacre 1770

Em 5 de março de 1770, uma multidão em Boston gritou com soldados britânicos. Algumas pessoas jogaram bolas de neve neles. A situação saiu do controle. Os soldados atiraram na multidão. Cinco colonos morreram. As pessoas chamaram isso de Massacre de Boston (*Boston Massacre*).

A maioria dos colonos culpou os soldados. O povo de Boston fez uma assembleia da cidade. Eles queriam que os soldados saíssem de Boston. Queriam que os soldados fossem julgados por assassinato. O governador de Massachusetts concordou. Os soldados saíram da cidade. Mais tarde, os soldados foram julgados.

Paul Revere imprimiu uma imagem famosa do acontecimento. Não é a imagem deste cartaz. Ela se espalhou rápido, então muitos colonos ficaram com mais raiva ainda. Mas a imagem não mostrava a história toda. O que aconteceu naquela noite foi mais confuso do que a imagem. John Adams foi o advogado dos soldados no tribunal. Nem todo mundo concordava sobre quem era o culpado.

6. Boston Tea Party 1773

Em 1773, o Parlamento aprovou a Lei do Chá (*Tea Act*). A lei ajudava uma companhia britânica, a Companhia das Índias Orientais (*East India Company*). A lei deixava a companhia vender chá muito barato. Isso prejudicou os vendedores das colônias, porque eles não conseguiam vender chá por um preço tão baixo.

O chá estava mais barato. Mas ainda tinha um imposto. Os colonos não tinham votado nesse imposto. Se comprassem o chá, seria como dizer que o Parlamento podia cobrar impostos deles. Então, isso era de novo **taxação sem representação** (*taxation without representation*).

Para protestar, os Filhos da Liberdade planejaram a Festa do Chá de Boston (*Boston Tea Party*). Alguns colonos se fantasiaram de indígenas mohawk. Assim, ninguém saberia quem eles eram. Eles subiram em três navios que levavam o chá da companhia. Jogaram 342 baús de chá no porto de Boston. Um **baú** é uma caixa grande de madeira. Uma grande multidão assistia.

7. Intolerable (Coercive) Acts 1774

Coagir (*to coerce*) quer dizer forçar alguém a fazer algo. Depois da Festa do Chá, a Grã-Bretanha queria punir Boston. Por isso, em 1774, o Parlamento aprovou as Leis Coercitivas (*Coercive Acts*). Essas leis fecharam o porto de Boston, então os navios não podiam entrar nem sair. O porto ficaria fechado até Boston pagar pelo chá. O rei também colocou um general do exército, Thomas Gage, no comando de Massachusetts. Mais soldados chegaram a Boston. As leis também limitaram as assembleias das cidades.

Os colonos ficaram chocados. Eles chamaram as leis de **Leis Intoleráveis** (*Intolerable Acts*). **Intolerável** quer dizer duro demais para aceitar. As leis só puniam Massachusetts. Mas as outras colônias ficaram preocupadas, porque elas podiam ser as próximas. Por isso, elas se juntaram ao protesto. Algumas colônias mandaram comida para Boston.

Perto de Boston, os milicianos chamados *minutemen* se prepararam para lutar. Os **minutemen** eram colonos que podiam ficar prontos para lutar muito rápido, “em um minuto”. Eles guardaram armas e pólvora e treinaram para a batalha.

8. First Continental Congress 1774

Depois das Leis Intoleráveis, as colônias decidiram trabalhar juntas. Elas sabiam que eram mais fortes juntas do que sozinhas. Queriam contar suas queixas à Grã-Bretanha como um só grupo.

Em 1774, líderes de 12 das 13 colônias se reuniram na Filadélfia. Essa reunião foi chamada de **Primeiro Congresso Continental** (*First Continental Congress*). Um **congresso** é uma reunião de pessoas escolhidas para falar pelos outros. Samuel Adams, John Adams, George Washington e Patrick Henry estavam lá.

Eles se reuniram por cerca de sete semanas. Escreveram os direitos que acreditavam que os colonos tinham. Mandaram uma carta ao rei. Também combinaram um grande **boicote** (*boycott*). Primeiro, os colonos parariam de comprar produtos britânicos. Depois, se a Grã-Bretanha não ouvisse, eles também parariam de vender produtos para a Grã-Bretanha. Grupos locais garantiam que as pessoas obedecessem ao boicote.

9. Lexington & Concord 1775

A Grã-Bretanha não deu ao Primeiro Congresso Continental o que ele pediu. Em abril de 1775, soldados britânicos saíram de Boston. Eles foram para as cidades de Lexington e Concord. Queriam pegar as armas e a pólvora dos colonos. Os colonos tinham medo de que os soldados também quisessem prender dois líderes, Samuel Adams e John Hancock. Paul Revere cavalgou à noite para avisá-los.

Em Lexington, os minutemen enfrentaram os soldados britânicos. Alguém deu um tiro, mas ninguém sabe quem atirou primeiro. Oito colonos foram mortos. Depois, os britânicos seguiram para Concord. Lá, mais minutemen lutaram contra eles.

Os britânicos voltaram para Boston. No caminho, os colonos atiraram neles de trás de árvores e cercas. À noite, muito mais soldados britânicos do que colonos estavam feridos ou mortos.

Em junho de 1775, o Segundo Congresso Continental (*Second Continental Congress*) escolheu George Washington para comandar o exército dos colonos. A Guerra de Independência dos Estados Unidos (*Revolutionary War*) tinha começado.

Quick in Русский

The Quick readings, translated. Key unit terms keep the English word beside the translation.

1. Proclamation of 1763 1763

Франко-индейская война закончилась в 1763 году. Британия победила. После войны Британия объявила своими земли к западу от Аппалачских гор.

В том же году король Британии издал новое правило. Оно называлось **«Прокламация 1763 года»** (*Proclamation of 1763*). **Прокламация** — это официальный приказ. В правиле говорилось, что колонисты не могут селиться к западу от гор. На этих землях уже жили народы коренных американцев (индейцев). Король сказал, что колонисты должны держаться оттуда подальше.

Британия ввела это правило, потому что хотела избежать новых войн с коренными американцами. Но многие колонисты рассердились. Они хотели переехать на запад, чтобы получить хорошую и дешёвую землю для ферм. Теперь они не могли этого сделать. Правило также показало, что Британия хочет больше власти над колониями.

2. Quartering Act 1765

Расквартировать (*to quarter*) солдат — значит дать им место, где жить. В 1765 году Парламент принял Закон о расквартировании (*Quartering Act*). **Парламент** — это группа людей, которая принимает законы для Британии. В этом законе говорилось, что колонии должны давать британским солдатам места для жилья. Солдаты жили в казармах, гостиницах и пустых зданиях. **Казармы** — это здания, где живут солдаты. Закон не заставлял семьи селить солдат у себя дома. Колонии также должны были давать солдатам топливо, свечи и перевозку с места на место. За всё это должны были платить колонии.

Многие колонисты рассердились. Они не доверяли солдатам. Они думали, что солдаты пришли, чтобы управлять ими, а не защищать их. Колонисты также считали, что Британия должна была сначала спросить их.

3. Stamp Act 1765

После Франко-индейской войны Британия задолжала много денег. Британские лидеры считали, что колонисты должны помочь заплатить за свою же защиту. Поэтому в 1765 году Парламент принял Закон о гербовом сборе (*Stamp Act*). **Парламент** — это группа людей, которая принимает законы для Британии. Закон о гербовом сборе был **налогом** на бумажные вещи, например на газеты и игральные

карты. Налог — это деньги, которые люди обязаны платить правительству. Колонисты должны были покупать специальную гербовую марку (*stamp*), чтобы показать, что они заплатили.

Колонисты рассердились, потому что не могли голосовать ни за кого в Парламенте. Там никто не говорил от их имени. Они назвали это **налогообложением без представительства** (*taxation without representation*).

Колонисты сопротивлялись по-разному. «Сыны свободы» (*Sons of Liberty*) запугали продавцов гербовых марок, и те отказались от этой работы. Торговцы (люди, которые продают товары) начали **бойкот** (*boycott*). Бойкот — это когда люди вместе договариваются не покупать что-то в знак протеста. Они отказались покупать британские товары. Лидеры из девяти колоний встретились. Эта встреча называлась Конгрессом против гербового сбора (*Stamp Act Congress*). Они попросили Британию **отменить** (*repeal*) закон. Отменить закон — значит сделать так, чтобы он больше не действовал.

В 1766 году Парламент действительно отменил Закон о гербовом сборе. Но в тот же день Парламент принял другой закон. В нём говорилось, что Парламент всё ещё может принимать законы для колоний. Поэтому гнев не прошёл.

4. Townshend Acts 1767

В 1767 году Парламент ввёл новые налоги. Эти законы назвали законами Тауншенда (*Townshend Acts*). Их придумал британский лидер Чарльз Тауншенд (Charles Townshend). Это были налоги на стекло, свинец, краску, бумагу и чай. Налоги платили в портах, когда приходили корабли. Поэтому налог был спрятан в цене товара в магазине. Тауншенд надеялся, что колонисты не будут так сильно злиться.

Но колонисты заметили эти налоги. Они всё ещё не могли голосовать ни за кого в Парламенте. Поэтому они снова назвали это **налогообложением без представительства** (*taxation without representation*). В знак протеста колонисты начали ещё один **бойкот** (*boycott*). Они отказались покупать британские товары.

В 1770 году Парламент **отменил** (*repealed*) большую часть этих налогов. Отменить закон — значит сделать так, чтобы он больше не действовал. Но Парламент оставил налог на чай.

5. Boston Massacre 1770

5 марта 1770 года толпа в Бостоне кричала на британских солдат. Некоторые люди бросали в них снежки. Всё вышло из-под контроля. Солдаты выстрелили в толпу. Пять колонистов погибли. Люди назвали это Бостонской бойней (*Boston Massacre*).

Большинство колонистов обвинили солдат. Жители Бостона провели городское собрание. Они хотели, чтобы солдаты ушли из Бостона. Они хотели, чтобы солдат судили за убийство. Губернатор Массачусетса согласился. Солдаты ушли из города. Позже солдат судили.

Пол Ревир (Paul Revere) напечатал известный рисунок об этом событии. Это не тот рисунок, что на этой карточке. Рисунок быстро разошёлся, и многие колонисты рассердились ещё сильнее. Но рисунок показывал не всю историю. На самом деле в ту ночь всё было запутаннее, чем на рисунке. Джон Адамс (John Adams) был адвокатом солдат в суде. Люди спорили о том, кто виноват.

6. Boston Tea Party 1773

В 1773 году Парламент принял Чайный закон (*Tea Act*). Закон помогал одной британской компании — Ост-Индской компании (*East India Company*). Он позволял компании продавать чай очень дёшево. Это навредило продавцам в колониях, потому что они не могли продавать чай по такой низкой цене.

Чай стал дешевле. Но на нём всё ещё был налог. Колонисты не голосовали за этот налог. Если бы они купили чай, это было бы как согласие с тем, что Парламент может брать с них налоги. Поэтому это снова было **налогообложение без представительства** (*taxation without representation*).

В знак протеста «Сыны свободы» устроили Бостонское чаепитие (*Boston Tea Party*). Некоторые колонисты переоделись индейцами-могавками. Так никто не мог узнать, кто они. Они поднялись на три корабля, которые везли чай компании. Они выбросили 342 сундука с чаем в Бостонскую гавань. **Сундук** — это большой деревянный ящик. Большая толпа смотрела на это.

7. Intolerable (Coercive) Acts 1774

Принуждать (*to coerce*) — значит заставлять кого-то что-то делать. После Бостонского чаепития Британия хотела наказать Бостон. Поэтому в 1774 году Парламент принял Принудительные законы (*Coercive Acts*). Эти законы закрыли порт Бостона, и корабли не могли ни войти, ни выйти. Порт должен был оставаться закрытым, пока Бостон не заплатит за чай. Король также поставил во главе Массачусетса армейского генерала Томаса Гейджа (Thomas Gage). В Бостон пришло больше солдат. Законы также ограничили городские собрания.

Колонисты были потрясены. Они назвали эти законы **Невыносимыми законами** (*Intolerable Acts*). **Невыносимый** — значит слишком жёсткий, чтобы его терпеть. Законы наказывали только Массачусетс. Но другие колонии волновались, потому что

следующими могли стать они. Поэтому они присоединились к протесту. Некоторые колонии отправили в Бостон еду.

Рядом с Бостоном минитмены (ополченцы, *minutemen*) готовились к бою. **Минитмены** — это колонисты, которые могли очень быстро, «за минуту», подготовиться к бою. Они запасали оружие и порох и учились воевать.

8. First Continental Congress 1774

После Невыносимых законов колонии решили действовать вместе. Они знали, что вместе они сильнее, чем поодиночке. Они хотели высказать Британии свои жалобы как одна группа.

В 1774 году лидеры 12 колоний из 13 встретились в Филадельфии. Эта встреча называлась **Первым Континентальным конгрессом** (*First Continental Congress*). **Конгресс** — это собрание людей, которых выбрали, чтобы говорить от имени других. Там были Сэмюэл Адамс, Джон Адамс, Джордж Вашингтон и Патрик Генри.

Они заседали около семи недель. Они записали права, которые, по их мнению, были у колонистов. Они отправили письмо королю. Они также договорились о большом **бойкоте** (*boycott*). Сначала колонисты перестанут покупать британские товары. Потом, если Британия не послушает, они перестанут и продавать товары в Британию. Местные группы следили, чтобы люди соблюдали бойкот.

9. Lexington & Concord 1775

Британия не дала Первому Континентальному конгрессу того, о чём он просил. В апреле 1775 года британские солдаты вышли из Бостона. Они пошли в города Лексингтон и Конкорд. Они хотели забрать у колонистов оружие и порох. Колонисты боялись, что солдаты также хотят поймать двух лидеров — Сэмюэла Адамса и Джона Хэнкока. Пол Ревир ночью поскакал на коне, чтобы предупредить их.

В Лексингтоне минитмены встретили британских солдат. Кто-то выстрелил, но никто не знает, кто выстрелил первым. Восемь колонистов были убиты. Потом британцы пошли дальше, в Конкорд. Там с ними сражались другие минитмены.

Британцы повернули обратно в Бостон. По дороге колонисты стреляли в них из-за деревьев и заборов. К ночи британских солдат было ранено или убито гораздо больше, чем колонистов.

В июне 1775 года Второй Континентальный конгресс (*Second Continental Congress*) выбрал Джорджа Вашингтона командовать армией колонистов. Началась Война за независимость США (*Revolutionary War*).

Quick in 中文（简体）

The Quick readings, translated. Key unit terms keep the English word beside the translation.

1. Proclamation of 1763 1763

法国 – 印第安人战争在1763年结束了。英国赢了。战争结束后，英国宣称阿巴拉契亚山脉以西的土地归它所有。

同一年，英国国王发布了一条新规定。它叫做**《1763年公告》**（*Proclamation of 1763*）。**公告**就是官方发布的命令。这条规定说，殖民地居民不能到山脉以西去定居。美洲原住民的各个民族早就生活在那片土地上。国王说，殖民地居民不能进入那里。

英国定下这条规定，是因为它想避免和美洲原住民再打仗。可是很多殖民地居民很生气。他们想搬到西部，去找又好又便宜的农田。现在他们不能去了。这条规定也说明，英国想要更多地控制殖民地。

2. Quartering Act 1765

安置（*to quarter*）士兵，就是给士兵安排住的地方。1765年，英国议会通过了《驻营法》（*Quartering Act*）。**议会**是为英国制定法律的机构。这条法律说，殖民地必须给英国士兵提供住处。士兵住在兵营、旅店和空房子里。**兵营**是士兵住的房子。这条法律没有强迫家庭让士兵住进自己家里。殖民地还必须给士兵提供燃料、蜡烛和交通工具。这些全都要由殖民地出钱。

很多殖民地居民很生气。他们不信任这些士兵。他们认为士兵来这里是为了控制他们，而不是保护他们。殖民地居民还觉得，英国应该先问问他们。

3. Stamp Act 1765

法国 – 印第安人战争以后，英国欠了很多钱。英国领导人认为，殖民地居民应该帮忙支付保护他们自己的费用。所以在1765年，英国议会通过了《印花税法》（*Stamp Act*）。**议会**是为英国制定法律的机构。《印花税法》是对纸制品收的一种**税**，比如报纸和扑克牌。税就是人们必须交给政府的钱。殖民地居民必须买一张印花税票，证明他们已经交了税。

殖民地居民很生气，因为他们不能投票选举任何人进入议会。议会里没有人替他们说话。他们把这叫做**“没有代表权却要纳税”**（*taxation without representation*）。

殖民地居民用很多方法进行反抗。“自由之子”（*Sons of Liberty*）吓得卖印花税票的人都辞职不干了。商人们（卖东西的人）发起了**抵制**（*boycott*）。抵制就是大家约好一起不买某种东西，来表示抗议。他们拒绝买英国的商品。来自九个殖民地的领导人开了一次会。这次会议叫做“印花税法大会”（*Stamp Act Congress*）。他们要求英国**废除**（*repeal*）这条法律。废除就是取消一条法律。

1766年，英国议会真的废除了《印花税法》。可是就在同一天，议会又通过了另一条法律。这条法律说，议会仍然可以为殖民地制定法律。所以人们的怒气并没有消失。

4. Townshend Acts 1767

1767年，英国议会通过了新的税法，叫做《汤森法案》（*Townshend Acts*）。这些税是英国领导人查尔斯·汤森（Charles Townshend）计划的。这些税是对玻璃、铅、颜料、纸和茶叶征收的。税是在港口交的，也就是船到岸的时候。所以，税就藏在了商店里商品的价格中。汤森希望殖民地居民不会那么生气。

可是殖民地居民还是注意到了这些税。他们仍然不能投票选举任何人进入议会。所以他们又一次把这叫做**“没有代表权却要纳税”**（*taxation without representation*）。为了抗议，殖民地居民又发起了一次**抵制**（*boycott*）。他们拒绝买英国的商品。

1770年，英国议会**废除**（*repealed*）了这些税中的大部分。废除就是取消一条法律。可是议会保留了茶叶税。

5. Boston Massacre 1770

1770年3月5日，波士顿的一群人对着英国士兵大喊大叫。有些人向士兵扔雪球。局面失去了控制。士兵向人群开了枪。五名殖民地居民死了。人们把这件事叫做“波士顿惨案”（*Boston Massacre*）。

大多数殖民地居民都怪罪士兵。波士顿的居民召开了城镇会议。他们要求士兵离开波士顿。他们要求以谋杀罪审判这些士兵。马萨诸塞的总督同意了。士兵搬出了城镇。后来，这些士兵受到了审判。

保罗·里维尔（Paul Revere）印制了一幅关于这件事的著名图画。它不是这张卡片上的这幅画。这幅画传得很快，所以很多殖民地居民变得更加愤怒。可是这幅画并没有展示事情的全部。那天晚上真实发生的事情比画上的更混乱。约翰·亚当斯（John Adams）在法庭上担任了这些士兵的律师。对于该怪谁，人们的看法并不一致。

6. Boston Tea Party 1773

1773年，英国议会通过了《茶叶法》（*Tea Act*）。这条法律帮助了一家英国公司——东印度公司（*East India Company*）。它让这家公司可以非常便宜地卖茶叶。这伤害了殖民地的商人，因为他们没办法用这么低的价格卖茶叶。

茶叶变便宜了。可是茶叶上仍然有税。殖民地居民没有投票同意这项税。如果他们买了这些茶叶，就好像承认议会有权向他们征税。所以，这又是**“没有代表权却要纳税”**（*taxation without representation*）。

为了抗议，“自由之子”策划了波士顿倾茶事件（*Boston Tea Party*）。一些殖民地居民打扮成莫霍克印第安人的样子。这样，就没有人知道他们是谁了。他们登上了三艘装着东印度公司茶叶的

船。他们把342箱茶叶倒进了波士顿港。这里的“**箱**”指的是很大的木箱。一大群人在旁边看着。

7. Intolerable (Coercive) Acts 1774

强制（*to coerce*）就是强迫别人做某件事。波士顿倾茶事件以后，英国想惩罚波士顿。所以在1774年，英国议会通过了《强制法案》（*Coercive Acts*）。这些法律关闭了波士顿港，所以船既不能进来，也不能出去。港口要一直关闭，直到波士顿赔偿茶叶的钱。国王还派了一位陆军将军托马斯·盖奇（Thomas Gage）来管理马萨诸塞。更多的士兵来到了波士顿。这些法律还限制了城镇会议。

殖民地居民非常震惊。他们把这些法律叫做**《不可容忍法案》**（*Intolerable Acts*）。**不可容忍**就是太严厉了，让人无法接受。这些法律只惩罚马萨诸塞。可是其他殖民地很担心，因为下一个可能就是他们。所以他们也加入了抗议。一些殖民地给波士顿送去了食物。

在波士顿附近，“一分钟人”（民兵，*minutemen*）准备战斗。**一分钟人**是能够很快、“一分钟之内”就准备好战斗的殖民地居民。他们储存枪支和火药，并且进行作战训练。

8. First Continental Congress 1774

《不可容忍法案》以后，各个殖民地决定一起合作。他们知道，团结起来比单独行动更有力量。他们想作为一个整体，向英国表达他们的不满。

1774年，来自13个殖民地中12个殖民地的领导人在费城开会。这次会议叫做**第一届大陆会议**（*First Continental Congress*）。这里的“**会议**”（*congress*）指的是：由一些被选出来、替别人说话的人开的会。塞缪尔·亚当斯、约翰·亚当斯、乔治·华盛顿和帕特里克·亨利都参加了。

他们开了大约七个星期的会。他们写下了他们认为殖民地居民本来就拥有的权利。他们给国王写了一封信。他们还同意进行一次大规模的**抵制**（*boycott*）。首先，殖民地居民将不再买英国的商品。以后，如果英国不听，他们也将不再把商品卖给英国。各地的小组负责确保大家都参加抵制。

9. Lexington & Concord 1775

英国没有答应第一届大陆会议的要求。1775年4月，英国士兵从波士顿出发。他们前往列克星敦和康科德这两个城镇。他们想收缴殖民地居民的枪支和火药。殖民地居民担心，士兵还想抓住两位领导人：塞缪尔·亚当斯和约翰·汉考克。保罗·里维尔连夜骑马去警告他们。

在列克星敦，“一分钟人”迎面遇上了英国士兵。有人开了一枪，但是没有人知道是谁先开的枪。八名殖民地居民被打死。然后，英国士兵继续前往康科德。在那里，更多的“一分钟人”和他们作战。

英国士兵转身返回波士顿。在路上，殖民地居民躲在树木和篱笆后面向他们开枪。到了晚上，英国士兵受伤或死亡的人数比殖民地居民多得多。

1775年6月，第二届大陆会议（*Second Continental Congress*）选择乔治·华盛顿来领导殖民地居民的军队。美国独立战争（*Revolutionary War*）开始了。
